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Words have no power to impress the mind without the exquisite horror of their reality

EDGAR ALLAN POE

A

ACTOR

Of Persons Artificiall, some have their words and actions Owned by those whom they represent. And then the Person is the Actor; and he that owneth his words and actions, is the AUTHOR: In which case the Actor acteth by Authority. For that which in speaking of goods and possessions, is called an Owner, and in latine Dominus, in Greeke Kurios; speaking of Actions, is called Author. And as the Right of possession, is called Dominion; so the Right of doing any Action, is called AUTHORITY. So that by Authority, is alwayes understood a Right of doing any act: and Done By Authority, done by Commission, or Licence from him whose right it is. **THOMAS HOBBES, LEVIATHAN (1651)**

AFFECT, AFFECTION

Neither word denotes a personal feeling (*sentiment* in Deleuze and Guattari). *L'affect* (Spinoza's *affectus*) is an ability to affect and be affected. It is a pre-personal intensity corresponding to the passage from one experiential state of the body to another and implying an augmentation or diminution in that body's capacity to act. *L'affection* (Spinoza's *affectio*) is each such state considered as an encounter between the affected body and a second—affecting—body (with body taken in its broadest possible sense to include “mental” or ideal bodies). **DELEUZE & GUATTARI, A THOUSAND PLATEAUS (1987)**

ANALOGIES

When Le Corbusier compared the edifice with a machine he saw an analogy where nobody saw one before. When

Aalto compared the design of his organically shaped vases with the Finnish landscape, or his design for a theatre in Germany with a tree stump, he did the same; and when Haring designed with anthropomorphic images in mind he again did just that—seeing an analogy where nobody has seen one before. In the course of the twentieth century it has become recognized that analogy in the most general sense plays a far more important role in architectural design than that of simply following functional requirements or solving pure technical problems. All the constructivist designs for instance, have to be seen as a reference to the dynamic world of machines, factories and industrial components to which they are analogous. [...]

It has been said that scientific discovery consists in seeing analogies where everybody else sees just bare facts. [...] The analogy establishes a similarity, or the existence of some similar principles, between two events that are otherwise completely different. Kant considered the analogy as something indispensable to extend knowledge. In employing the method of analogy it should be possible to develop new concepts and to discover new relationships.

O. M. UNGERS, *MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS* (1982)

AGENT

agent (n.) 1471 in Ripley's *The Comprehend of Alchemy*, perhaps influenced by Old French *agent*, but probably borrowed from latin *agentem* (nominative *agens*), present participle of *agere* 'to do, act, lead, drive.' The Latin *agere* is cognate with Greek *agein* to lead, Sanskrit *ajati* '(he) drives,' Tocharian *ak-* 'to travel, lead,' and Old Icelandic *aka* 'to travel'; all tracable to the Indo-European base *ag-*, with the meaning "drive." **CHAMBERS DICT. OF ETYMOLOGY** (2019)

ARSENAL

- 1 A collection of weapons and military equipment.
- 1.1 A place where weapons and military equipment are stored or made.
- 1.2 An array of resources available for a certain purpose.

OXFORD DICTIONARY OF ENGLISH, 3RD EDITION (1989)

ASSEMBLAGE

[An assemblage] is a multiplicity which is made up of many heterogeneous terms and which establishes liaisons, relations between them, across ages, sexes and reigns—different natures. Thus, the assemblage's only unity is that of co-functioning: it is a symbiosis, a 'sympathy.' It is never filiations that are important, but alliances, alloys; these are not successions, lines of descent, but contagions, epidemics, the wind. [...] An assemblage is never technological; if anything, it is the opposite. Tools always presuppose a machine, and the machine is always social before being technical. There is always a social machine that selects or assigns the technical elements used. A tool remains marginal, or little used, until there exists a social machine or collective assemblage that is capable of taking it into its 'phylum.' [...] How can the assemblage be refused the name it deserves, 'desire'? [...] it is the set of the affects which are transformed and circulate in an assemblage of symbiosis, defined by the co-functioning of its heterogeneous parts.

First, in an assemblage there are, as it were, two faces, or at least two heads. There are the states of things, states of bodies (bodies interpenetrate, mix together, transmit affects to one another); but also utterances, regimes of utterances: signs are organized in a new way, new

formulations appear, a new style for new gestures (the emblems which individualize the knight, the formulas of oaths, the system of 'declarations,' even of love, etc.) Utterances are not part of ideology, there is no ideology: utterances, no less than states of things, are components and cog-wheels in the assemblage.

[...] There is no assemblage without territory, without territoriality and reterritorializations that includes all sorts of artifices. But is there any assemblage without a point of deterritorialization, without a line of flight that leads it on to new creations, or else towards death?

[...] Desire is revolutionary because it always wants more connections and assemblages.

[...] Desire is always assembled and fabricated, on a plane of immanence or of composition that must itself be constructed at the same time as desire assembles and fabricates. We do not simply mean that desire is historically determined. Historical determination involves a structural instance to play the role of law, or of cause, as a result of which desire is born. But desire is the real agent, merging each time with the variables of an assemblage. It is not lack or privation which leads to desire: one only feels lack in relation to an assemblage from which one is excluded, but one only desires as a result of an assemblage in which one is included (even if this were an association for banditry or revolt).

[...] The minimum real unit is not the word, the idea, the concept or the signifier, but the assemblage. It is always an assemblage that produces utterances. Utterances do not have as their cause a subject that would act as a subject of enunciation, any more than they are related to subjects as subjects of utterance. The utterance is the product of an assemblage –which is always collective, which brings into play within us and outside us populations, multiplicities, territories, becomings, affects, events. The proper name

does not designate a subject, but something that happens, at least between two terms which are not subjects, but agents, elements. **GILLES DELEUZE & CLAIRE PARNET, DIALOGUES (1977)**

BEAUTY

B

Beauty hates ideas. It is self-sufficient. A work of art is beautiful as someone may be beautiful. This beauty I am talking about... provokes an erection of the soul. You do not argue about an erection... Our time is drying out by dint of chitchat and ideas. **JEAN COCTEAU, POÉSIE CRITIQUE 1 (1959) TRANS. VOLUPTAS**

BODY

The surprising thing is the body...
we do not know yet what a body is capable of...

BARUCH SPINOZA, UNKNOWN (CA. 1670)

CADAVRE-EXQUIS

C

[...] designed to provide the most paradoxical confrontation possible between the elements of speech.

[...] Because of their primary function as proposed *delineations of personalities*, the *cadavres* tend inevitably to raise anthropomorphism to its highest pitch and to accentuate vividly the continuing relationship uniting the exterior world with the interior world. **ANDRÉ BRETON, THE EXQUISITE CORPSE, ITS EXALTATION (1948)**

COLLECTION

One need only study with due exactitude the physiognomy of the homes of great collectors. Then one would have the key to the nineteenth-century interior. Just as in the former case the objects gradually take possession of the residence, so in the latter it is a piece of furniture that would retrieve and assemble the stylistic traces of the centuries. [I 3, 2]

WALTER BENJAMIN, THE ARCADES PROJECT (1927–1940)

COMEDY

Theophile Gautier said that the comic in its extreme form was the logic of the absurd. [...] Every comic effect, it is said, implies contradiction in some of its aspects. What makes us laugh is alleged to be the absurd realised in concrete shape, a “palpable absurdity”;—or, again, an apparent absurdity, which we swallow for the moment only to rectify it immediately afterwards;—or, better still, something absurd from one point of view though capable of a natural explanation from another, etc. [...] Absurdity, when met within the comic, is not absurdity in general. It is an absurdity of a definite kind. It does not create the comic; rather, we might say that the comic infuses into it its own particular essence. It is not a cause, but an effect—an effect of a very special kind, which reflects the special nature of its cause.

[...] Laughter, as we have seen, is incompatible with emotion. If there exists a madness that is laughable, it can only be one compatible with the general health of the mind,—a sane type of madness, one might say. Now, there is a sane state of the mind that resembles madness in every respect, in which we find the same associations of ideas as we do in lunacy, the same peculiar logic as in a fixed idea.

This state is that of dreams. So either our analysis is incorrect, or it must be capable of being stated in the following theorem: comic absurdity is of the same nature as that of dreams. [...] If comic illusion is similar to dream illusion, if the logic of the comic is the logic of dreams, we may expect to discover in the logic of the laughable all the peculiarities of dream logic. [...] We shall first call attention to a certain general relaxation of the rules of reasoning. The reasonings at which we laugh are those we know to be false, but which we might accept as true were we to hear them in a dream. They counterfeit true reasoning just sufficiently to deceive a mind dropping off to sleep. There is still an element of logic in them, if you will, but it is a logic lacking in tension and, for that very reason, affording us relief from intellectual effort. **HENRI BERGSON, LAUGHTER (1900)**

DESIRE

D

So we were saying a simple thing: desire concerns speeds and slownesses between particles (longitude), affects, intensities and hecceities in degrees of power (latitude). A VAMPIRE—TO SLEEP—DAY—AND—TO WAKE UP—NIGHT. Do you realize how simple a desire is? Sleeping is a desire. Walking is a desire. Listening to music, or making music, or writing, are desires. A spring, a winter, are desires. Old age also is a desire. Even death. Desire never needs interpreting, it is it which experiments. Then we run up against very exasperating objections. They say to us that we are returning to an old cult of pleasure, to a pleasure principle, or to a notion of the festival (the revolution will be a festival...) [...] And above all, it is objected that by releasing desire from lack and law, the only thing we have left to refer to is a state of nature, a desire which would be natural and spontaneous reality. We

say quite the opposite: *desire only exists when assembled or machined*. You cannot grasp or conceive of a desire outside a determinate assemblage, on a plane which is not pre-existent but which must itself be constructed. All that is important is that each group or individual should construct the plane of immanence on which the lead their life and carry on their buisness. Without these conditions you obviously do lack something, but you lack precisely the conditions that make desire possible. [...] In retrospect every assemblage expresses and creates a desire by constructing the plane that makes it possible and, by making it possible, brings it about. [...] It is in itself an immanent revolutionary process. It is constructivist, not at all spontaneist. Since every assemblage is collective, is itself a collective, it is indeed true that every desire is the affair of the people, or an affair of the masses, a molecular affair. **DELEUZE & PARNET, DIALOGUES (1977)**

DETOURNEMENT

Any elements, no matter where they are taken from, can be used to make new combinations. The discovery of modern poetry regarding the analogical structure of images demonstrates that when two objects are brought together, no matter how far apart their original contexts may be, a relationship is always formed. **DEBORD & VOLMAN, A USER'S GUIDE TO DETOURNEMENT (1956)**

DISCOURSE

Of the modes of persuasion furnished by the spoken work there are three kinds. The first kind depends on the personal character of the speaker [ethos]; the second on putting the

audience into a certain frame of mind [pathos]; the third on the proof, or apparent proof, provided by the words of the speech itself [logos]. Persuasion is achieved by the speaker's personal character when the speech is so spoken as to make us think him credible. **ARISTOTLE, RHETORIC (4TH C. BC)**

EPITOME

1. Person or thing that is typical of, or possesses to a high degree the features of a whole class. 2. Condensed account, abstract. **RANDOM HOUSE UNABRIDGED DICTIONARY (2022)**

EQUIVOCAL

It was this deficiency, I considered, while running over in thought the perfect keeping of the character of the premises with the accredited character of the people, and while speculating upon the possible influence which the one, in the long lapse of centuries, might have exercised upon the other—it was this deficiency, perhaps, of collateral issue, and the consequent undeviating transmission, from sire to son, of the patrimony with the name, which had, at length, so identified the two as to merge the original title of the estate in the quaint and equivocal appellation of the “House of Usher”—an appellation which seemed to include, in the minds of the peasantry who used it, both the family and the family mansion. **E. A. POE, THE FALL OF THE HOUSE USHER (1839)**

ERROR

All life rests on appearance, art, illusion, optics, the need for

perspective and for error. **NIETZSCHE, THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY (1886)**

F FATE

Whenever I've tried to free my life from a set of the circumstances that continuously oppress it, I've been instantly surrounded by other circumstances of the same order, as if the inscrutable web of creation were irrevocably at odds with me. I yank from my neck a hand that was choking me, and I see that my own hand is tied to a noose that fell around my neck when I freed it from the stranger's hand. When I gingerly remove the noose, it's with my own hands that I nearly strangle myself. **F. PESSOA, THE BOOK OF DISQUIET (1982)**

FICTION

History teaches that rise to power and responsibility affects deeply the nature of revolutionary parties. Experience and common sense were perfectly justified in expecting that totalitarianism in power would gradually lose its revolutionary momentum and Utopian character, that the everyday business of government and the possession of real power would moderate the prepower claims of the movements and gradually destroy the fictitious world of their organizations. It seems, after all, to be in the very nature of things, personal or public, that extreme demands and goals are checked by objective conditions; and reality, taken as a whole, is only to a very small extent determined by the inclination toward the fiction of a mass society of atomized individuals. **H. ARENDT, THE ORIGINS OF TOTALITARIANISM (1951)**

GHOST

—A dead king isn't a king.

JEAN COCTEAU, THE INFERNAL MACHINE, ACT 1 (1934)

HIGH-LIFE

Problem: How shall we impart to this sterile pile, this crude, harsh, brutal agglomeration, this stark, staring exclamation of eternal strife, the graciousness of those higher forms of sensibility and culture that rest on the lower and fiercer passions? How shall we proclaim from the dizzy height of this strange, weird, modern housetop the peaceful evangel of sentiment, of beauty, the cult of a higher life? **L. SULLIVAN, THE TALL OFFICE BUILDING ARTISTICALLY CONSIDERED (1896)**

HISTORY

History does not repeat itself, but it often rhymes.

MARK TWAIN (ATT.), UNKNOWN

For we know it well: in politics, nothing is more thrilling than the desire to start over, to pick up the torch of ancient struggles as one revives unkept promises. In that case, the past not only enlightens the present, it brightens it with a strong, explosive glimmer, one that, literally, sparks things off. Because time that passed is less an inert sediment than rather a fossil energy, always likely to reactivate itself, and this precipitate that is the accomplishment of the past in the present is called "history."

P. BOUCHERON, TRIBUNE, LE MONDE (20.07.2019) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

G

H

HYPER–

word-forming element: “over, above, beyond,” often implying “exceedingly, to excess,” from Greek *hyper* (prep. & adv.) “over, beyond, overmuch, above measure,” from PIE root *uper “over.” **ONLINE ETYMOLOGY DICTIONARY (2020)**

I IMAGE

I’ve always said that, in cinema, there were no images. There is always an image *before* and an image *after*. The Present does not exist in cinema. Monday does not exist. It’s always Sunday or Tuesday. And Monday is simply the link between the two. And that is the Image. And even the image does not exist. There is a text by Pierre Reverdy that states: “an image is never strong because it is dreadful or brutal but because the solidarity between the ideas is distant and true.” [...] Everything is always *in between*. The light is always in between day and night, between light and dark... Everything is *in between*... J.-L. GODARD, CINÉMA DES CINÉASTES (1982) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

IMAGES AND PERCEPTION

Probably all of us remember the story of the man in the moon which occupied our childhood fantasies, producing all sorts of images of an old man, carrying a bundle on his back, and whose face used to change depending on the clarity of the night. [...] Before human intelligence managed to uncover his secret, he was the subject of so many desires and wishes that he became part of our life while existing only in our imagination.

Not only about the moon, but also about the whole

firmament the human mind created a vivid fantasy. It probably took a long time to structure the wide starry sky, and to develop a coherent system within a chaotic reality long before science was capable of calculating and measuring the orbits, the gravity, the intensity of speed of light of the stars and to register relevant data. Before that, understanding was based entirely on imaginative concepts. Instead of a set of facts, knowledge referred to a set of constellations derived from perception. The firmament was filled with figures and images, such as the Orion, Castor and Pollux, the Great Bear, and others. Those stars represented a sensuous reality in the human consciousness. Therefore we might conclude: Reality is what our imagination perceives it to be. In a general sense, an image describes a set of facts in such a way that the same visual perception is connected with the conditions as with the image itself. O. M. UNGERS, MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS (1982)

ISLAND

The island would be only the dream of man, and man, the pure conscience of the island. For this, once again, only one condition: man should refer to the movement which brings him to the island, movement which extends and takes over the impulse which was producing the island.

G.DELEUZE, CAUSE ET RAISON DES ÎLES DÉSERTES (2002) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

LABYRINTH

The worst labyrinth is not that intricate form that can entrap us forever, but as single and precise straight line.

J.L. BORGES, UNKNOWN (XXTH C.)

LEITMOTIF

Proust loved Wagner for the high frequency of the leitmotifs, musical reminiscences that construct a familiar landscape.

MARTHE PEYROUX, YOURCENAR ET PROUST (1900) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

M MAZE

c. 1300, “delusion, bewilderment, confusion of thought,” possibly from Old English **mæs* – suggested by the compound *amasod* “amazed” and verb *amasian* “to confound, confuse” (see *amaze*). Of uncertain origin; perhaps related to Norwegian dialectal *mas* “exhausting labor,” Swedish *masa* “to be slow or sluggish.” Meaning “labyrinth, baffling network of paths or passages” is from late 14c. (on the notion of something intended to confuse or mislead). **ONLINE ETYMOLOGY DICTIONARY**. (2020)

MECHANISATION

Whether we find reciprocal interference of series, inversion, or repetition, we see that the objective is always the same – to obtain what we have called a mechanisation of life. You take a set of actions and relations and repeat it as it is, or turn it upside down, or transfer it bodily to another set with which it partially coincides – all these being processes that consist in looking upon life as a repeating mechanism, with reversible action and interchangeable parts. **BERGSON, LAUGHTER** (1900)

METAPHORS

In everyday language we are constantly using metaphorical

expressions without paying any attention to them. For instance, we talk about the foot of the mountain, the leg of the chair, the heart of the city, the mouth of the river, the long arm of the law, the head of the family and a body of knowledge. We use many words that are vivid metaphors although they exist as common expressions of metaphorical character such as: straight from the horse’s mouth, the tooth of time, or the tide of events, a forest of masts, the jungle of the city.

Metaphors are transformations of an actual event into a figurative expression, evoking images by substituting an abstract notion for something more descriptive and illustrative. It usually is an implicit comparison between two entities which are not alike but can be compared in an imaginative way. The comparison is mostly done through a creative leap that ties different objects together, producing a new entity in which the characteristics of both take parts. Designers use the metaphor as an instrument of thought that serves the function of clarity and vividness antedating or bypassing logical processes. *A metaphor is an intuitive perception of similarities in dissimilars*, as Aristotle defined it. **O. M. UNGERS, MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS** (1982)

MILIEU

In French, *milieu* means ‘surroundings,’ ‘medium’ (as in chemistry), and ‘middle.’ [...] ‘milieu’ should be read as a technical term combining all three meanings.

DELEUZE & GUATTARI, A THOUSAND PLEATEAUS (1987)

MODELS

A model is commonly understood as somebody who poses

as a prototype representing an ideal form. [...] Generally a model is a theoretical complexity in itself which either brings a visual form or a conceptual order into the components of complex situations. In such a model the external form is the expression of an internal structure. [...] To make a model means to find coherence in a given relationship of certain combinations and fixed dispositions. This is usually done with two types of models, visual models and thinking models. They serve as conceptual devices to structure our experiences and turn them into functions or make them intentional. By means of these two models we formulate an objective structure that turns facts into something more certain and therefore more real. It is nothing else than a formal principle which makes it possible to visualize the complexity of appearances in a more ordered way, and which in reverse is a creative approach to structured reality along the knowledge of a model. Not the least the model is an intellectual structure setting targets for our creative activities, just like the design of models-buildings, model-cities, model-communities, and other model conditions supposedly are setting directions for subsequent actions. **O. M. UNGERS, MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS (1982)**

MONTAGE

If direction is a look, montage is a heartbeat. To foresee is the characteristic of both: but what one seeks to foresee in space, the other seeks in time. Suppose you notice a young girl in the street who attracts you. You hesitate to follow her. A quarter of a second. How to convey this hesitation? *Mise en scène* will answer the question "How shall I approach her?" But in order to render explicit the other question, "Am I going to love her?", you are forced to bestow importance on

the quarter of a second during which the two questions are born. It may be, therefore, that it will be for the montage rather than the *mise en scène* to express both exactly and clearly the life of an idea or its sudden emergence in the course of a story. When? Without playing on words, each time the situation requires it, each time within a shot when a shock effect demands to take the place of an arabesque, each time between one scene and another when the inner continuity of the film enjoins with a change of shot the superimposition of the description of a character on that of the plot. This example shows that talking of *mise en scène* automatically implies montage. When montage effects surpass those of *mise en scène* in efficacy, the beauty of the latter is doubled, the unforeseen unveiling secrets by its charm in an operation analogous to using unknown quantities in mathematics. Anyone who yields to the temptation of montage yields also to the temptation of the brief shot. How? By making the look a key piece in his game. Cutting of a look is almost the definition of montage, its supreme ambition as well as its submission to *mise en scène*. It is, in effect, to bring out the soul under the spirit, the passion behind the intrigue, to make the heart prevail over the intelligence by destroying the notion of space in favor of that of time.

J.-L. GODARD, MONTAGE MY FINE CARE, IN: GODARD ON GODARD (1986)

MORPHOLOGY

There are three basic levels of comprehending physical phenomena: first, the exploration of pure physical facts; second the psychological impact on our inner-self; and third, the imaginative discovery and reconstruction of phenomena in order to conceptualize them. If, for instance, designing is understood purely technically, then it results

in pragmatic functionalism or in mathematical formulas. If designing is exclusively an expression of psychological experiences, then only emotional values matter, and it turns into a religious substitute. If, however, the physical reality is understood and conceptualized as an analogy to our imagination of that reality, then we pursue a morphological design concept, turning it into phenomena which, like all real concepts, can be expanded or condensed; they can be seen as polarities contradicting or complementing each other, existing as pure concepts in themselves like a piece of art. Therefore we might say, if we look at physical phenomena in a morphological sense, like Gestalten in their metamorphosis, we can manage to develop our knowledge without machine or apparatus. This imaginative process of thinking applies to all human activities though the approaches might be different in various fields. But it is always a fundamental process of conceptualizing an unrelated, diverse reality through the use of images, metaphors, analogies, models, signs, symbols and allegories.

O. M. UNGERS, MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS (1982)

MUSIC

Music expresses the spiritual, it inspires. When I am blind, music is my little Antigone, it helps to see the unbelievable. [...] I've always wished [...] for music to take over whenever it is no longer necessary to see the image, for it to express something else. What interests me, is to see the music, to try to see what one hears and to hear what one sees.

JEAN-LUC GODARD, IN: J.-L. DOUIN, JEAN-LUC GODARD (1994)

NARRATIVE

N

narrative (n.) 1. a spoken or written account of connected events; a story: *a gripping narrative*. 2. the narrated part of a literary work, as distinct from dialogue. 3. the practice or art of telling stories: traditions of oral narrative: *traditions of oral narratives*. 4. the representation in art of an event of story. OXFORD DICT. OF ENGLISH (1989)

narration (n.) act of narrating. Probably before 1425 *narracioun* 'act of telling a story or recounting in order the particulars of some action, occurrence, or affair,' also "that which is narrated or recounted, a story, an account of events'; borrowed from Old French *narration* 'account, statement, a relating, recounting, narrating, narrative tale', and from Latin *narration* (nominative *narratio*), 'a relating, narrative,' from *narrare* 'relate, recount, explain,' from a possible pre-Latin word **gnarare*, related to Old Latin *gnarus* 'knowing, skilled' literally 'to make acquainted with,' (also found in IGNORE); further related to *gnoscere*, *noscere* 'TO KNOW.' CHAMBERS DICT. OF ETYMOLOGY (2019)

NECESSITY

Man was created out of desire, not out of necessity.

GASTON BACHELARD, LA PSYCHANALYSE DU FEU (1949) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

PAIN AND PLEASURE

P

I. Nature has placed mankind under the governance of two sovereign masters, pain and pleasure. It is for them alone to point out what we ought to do, as well as to determine what

we shall do. On the one hand the standard of right and wrong, on the other the chain of causes and effects, are fastened to their throne. They govern us in all we do, in all we say, in all we think: every effort we can make to throw off our subjection, will serve but to demonstrate and confirm it. In words a man may pretend to abjure their empire: but in reality he will remain subject to it all the while. The principle of utility recognizes this subjection, and assumes it for the foundation of that system, the object of which is to rear the fabric of felicity by the hands of reason and of law. Systems which attempt to question it, deal in sounds instead of sense, in caprice instead of reason, in darkness instead of light.

J. BENTHAM, THE PRINCIPLES OF MORAL AND LEGISLATION (1789)

PASSAGE

According to Sir Roger Pratt, the passage was for servants: to keep them out of each other's way and, more important still, to keep them out of the way of gentlemen and ladies. There was nothing new in this fastidiousness, the novelty was in the conscious employment of architecture to dispel it – a measure in part of the antagonism between rich and poor in turbulent times, but also an augury of what was to render household life placid in years to come.

ROBIN EVANS, FIGURES, DOORS AND PASSAGES (1978) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

PERCEPT, AFFECT & CONCEPT

Style in philosophy tends towards these three poles, the concept or new ways of thinking, the percept or new ways of seeing and hearing, the affect of new ways of experiencing. It is the philosophical trinity, philosophy as opera: all three

are required to build a movement.

GILLES DELEUZE, POURPARLERS (1972–1990)

[...] the thing or the work of art—is a bloc of sensations, that is to say, a compound of percepts and affects. Percepts are no longer perceptions; they are independent of a state of those who experience them. Affects are no longer feelings or affections; they go beyond the strength of those who undergo them. Sensations, percepts, and affects are beings whose validity lies in themselves and exceeds any lived. They could be said to exist in the absence of man because man, as he is caught in stone, on the canvas, or by words, is himself a compound of percepts and affects. The work of art is a being of sensation and nothing else: it exists in itself. Harmonies are affects. Consonance and dissonance, harmonies of tone or color, are affects of music or painting.

[...] The artist creates blocs of percepts and affects, but the only law of creation is that the compound must stand up on its own. The artist's greatest difficulty is to make it *stand up on its own*. Sometimes this requires what is, from the viewpoint of an implicit model, from the viewpoint of livid perceptions and affections, great geometrical improbability, physical imperfection, and organic abnormality. But these sublime errors accede to the necessity of art if they are internal means of standing up (or sitting or lying).

[...] The three thoughts intersect and intertwine but without synthesis or identification. With its concepts, philosophy brings forth events. Art erects monuments with its sensations. Science constructs states of affairs with its functions. A rich tissue of correspondences can be established between the planes. But the network has its culminating points, where sensation itself becomes sensation of concept or function, where the concept becomes concept of function or of sensation, and where the function becomes function of

sensation or concept. And non of these elements can appear without the other being still to come, still indeterminate or unknown. Each created element on a plane calls on other heterogeneous elements, which are still to be created on other planes: thought as heterogenesis. **DELEUZE & GUATTARI, WHAT IS PHILOSOPHY? (1968)**

PROJECT

project (n./v.) 1. an individual or collective enterprise that is carefully planned to achieve a particular aim.
2. extend outwards beyond something else; protrude.
3. throw or cause to move forward or outward; cause (light, shadow, an image) to fall on a surface; cause (a sound) to be heard at a distance; imagine (oneself, a situation, etc.) as having moved to a different place or time. **ORIGIN:** late Middle English (in the sense ‘preliminary design, tabulated statement’): from Latin *projectum* ‘something prominent,’ neuter past participle of *proicere* ‘thrown forth,’ from *pro-* ‘forth’ + *jacere* ‘to throw.’ **OXFORD DICT. OF ENGLISH (1989)**

PROJECTILE

Projectiles—the inert membranes of fortresses and bunkers, the ‘metabolic bodies’ of soldiers, and transport bodies of naval vessels. **PAUL VIRILIO, SPEED AND POLITICS (1977)**

PROPERTY

I contend that neither labor, nor occupation, nor law, can create property; that it is an effect without a cause: am I

censurable? **PIERRE-JOSEPH PROUDHON, WHAT IS PROPERTY? (1840)**

REFERENCE

reference (n.) act of referring or fact of being referred; formed from English *refer* + *-ent*. The meaning of a direction to a book, passage, etc., where certain information may be found, is first recorded in 1612.

CHAMBERS DICTIONARY OF ETYMOLOGY (2019)

reference (n.) 1. the act of referring or consulting 2. a bearing on a matter: **RELATION** 3. something that refers: such as, a: **ALLUSION, MENTION** b: Something (such as a sign or indication) that refers to another source of information (such as a book or passage) c: Consultation of sources of information 4. One referred to or consulted: such as, a: a person to whom inquires as to character or ability can be made b: a statement of the qualifications of a person seeking employment or appointment given by someone familiar with the person c: i. a source of information (such as a book or passage) to which a reader or consulter is referred ii. a work (such as a dictionary or encyclopedia) containing useful facts or information.

MERRIAM WEBSTER ENGLISH DICTIONARY (2019)

REPERTOIRE

repertoire (n.) the list of plays, ballets, operas, parts, pieces, etc., that a company, actor, musician, or singer is prepared to perform. 1847, borrowing of French *répertoire*, learned borrowing from Late Latin *repertorium* ‘inventory.’

CHAMBERS DICTIONARY OF ETYMOLOGY (2019)

repertory (n.) 1. a: a list or supply of dramas, operas, pieces, or parts that a company or person is prepared to perform b: a supply of skills, devices, or expedients c: a list or supply of capabilities 2. a: the complete list or supply of dramas, operas, or musical works available for performance b: the complete list or supply of skills, devices, or ingredients used in a particular field, occupation, or practice. **OXFORD DICT. OF ENGLISH (2019)**

RISK

THE FUN THING ABOUT GAMES is RISK.

G. PEREC, IN: K. BOHMAN-KALAJA, READING GAMES (2007)

S SCENARIO

In the beginning, there was no scenario. The scenario was invented by the accountants who needed to know what Mack Sennett had been filming during the day. He filled a sheet of paper: a pair of socks, a car, three cops, a girl in a bathing suit... And then they added verbs and adjectives: "a girl in a bathing suit loves a cop who owns three cars..." And it was called "scenario"! But it is the money that made the scenario!

J.-L. GODARD, CINÉMA DES CINÉASTES (1982) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

SIGN

[...] The sign is usually said to be put in the place of the thing itself, the present thing, 'thing' here standing equally for meaning or referent. The sign represents the present in its absence. It takes the place of the present. When we cannot

grasp or show the thing, state the present, the being 'present' when the present cannot be presented, we signify, we go through the detour of the sign. We give or take signs. We signal. The sign, in this sense, is deferred presence. Whether we are concerned with the verbal or the written sign, with monetary sign, or with electoral delegation and political representation, the circulation of signs defers the moment in which we can encounter the thing itself, make it ours, consume or expend it, touch it, see it, intuit its presence. What I am describing here in order to define it is the classically determined structure of the sign in all the banality of its characteristics—signification as the *différance* of temporization. And this structure presupposes that the sign, which defers presence, is conceivable only on the basis of the presence that it defers and moving toward the deferred presence that it aims to reappropriate. According to this classical semiology, the substitution of the sign for the thing itself is both secondary and provisional: secondary due to an original and lost presence from which the sign thus derives; provisional as concerns this final and missing presence toward which the sign in this sense is a movement of mediation. J. DERRIDA, MARGINS OF PHILOSOPHY (1982)

SIGNS, SYMBOLS AND ALLEGORIES

[...] Almost all our communication is based on signs, symbols and allegories which structure most aspects of our daily routine but also are most often carriers of religious and metaphysical systems. [...] While signs point to something that they represent, as words are artificial signs for ideas and thoughts, symbols are a penetration of mind and image characterized by misery, depth, and inexhaustible interpretation.

[...] The method of allegory is represented in art whenever

it emphasizes thematic content and ideas rather than events and facts. The abiding impression left by the allegorical mode is one if indirect, ambiguous and sometimes even emblematic symbolism that inevitably calls for interpretation.

[...] What all that means—thinking and designing in images, metaphors, models, analogies, symbols and allegories—is nothing more than a transition from purely pragmatic approaches to a more creative mode of thinking. It means a process of thinking in qualitative values rather than quantitative data, a process that is based on synthesis alternate as breathing in and breathing out, as Goethe put it. It is meant to be a transition in the process of thinking from a metrical space to the visionary space of coherent systems, from the concepts of homology to the concepts of morphology.

O. M. UNGERS, MORPHOLOGIE, CITY METAPHORS (1982)

SITUATION

First, we believe that the world must be changed. We desire the most liberatory possible change of the society and the life in which we find ourselves confined. We know that such change is possible by means of pertinent actions.

[...] Our central idea is the construction of situations, that is to say, the concrete construction of momentary ambiances of life and their transformation into a superior passional quality. We must develop a systematic intervention based on the complex factors of two components in perpetual interaction: the material environment of life and the behaviours which that environment gives rise to and which radically transform it.

GUY DEBORD, REPORT ON THE CONSTRUCTION OF SITUATIONS (1957)

SOCIAL CONTRACT

Then I imagine a society where all, seeing the law as their work, would love it and would submit to it without difficulty; where since the authority of the government is respected as necessary and not as divine, the love that is felt for the head of State would be not a passion, but a reasoned and calm sentiment. Since each person has rights and is assured of preserving his rights, a manly confidence and a kind of reciprocal condescension, as far from pride as from servility, would be established among all classes.

Instructed in their true interests, the people would understand that, in order to take advantage of the good things of society, you must submit to its burdens. The free association of citizens would then be able to replace the individual power of the nobles, and the State would be sheltered from tyranny and from license.

ALEXIS DE TOCQUEVILLE, DEMOCRACY IN AMERICA (1835)

SPECULATION

Let us examine this point, and say, “God is, or God is not.” But to which side shall we incline? Reason can decide nothing here. [...] Let us weigh the gain and the loss in wagering that God is. Let us estimate these two chances. If you gain, you gain all; if you lose, you lose nothing. Wager then, without hesitation that He is.

[...] For it is no use to say it is uncertain if we will gain, and it is certain that we risk, and that the infinite distance between the certainty of what is staked and the uncertainty of what will be gained, equals the finite good which is certainly staked against the uncertain infinite.

[...] There is not an infinite distance between the

certainly staked and the uncertainty of the gain; that is untrue. In truth there is an infinity between the certainty of gain and the certainty of loss. But the uncertainty of the gain is proportioned to the certainty of the stake according to the proportion of the chances of gain and loss.

[...] And so our proposition is of infinite force, when there is the finite to stake in a game where there are equal risks of gain and of loss, and the infinite to gain.

BLAISE PASCAL, LES PENSÉES, VII (1669)

STORY

Sometimes reality is too complex. Stories give it form.

JEAN-LUC GODARD, UNKNOWN TRANS. VOLUPTAS

SUBLIME

Whatever is fitted in any sort to excite the ideas of pain, and danger, that is to say, whatever is in any sort terrible, or is conversant about terrible objects, or operates in a manner analogous to terror, is a source of the sublime; that is, it is productive of the strongest emotion, because I am satisfied the ideas of pain are much more powerful than those of pleasure. Without all doubt, the torments which we may be made to suffer, are much greater in their effect on the body and mind, than any pleasures which the most learned voluptuary could suggest, or than the liveliest imagination, and the most sound and exquisitely sensible body could enjoy. [...] When danger or pain press too nearly, they are incapable of giving any delight, and are simply terrible; but at certain distances, and with certain modifications, they may be, and they are delightful, as we

everyday experience.

EDMUND BURKE, A PHILOSOPHICAL ENQUIRY INTO THE ORIGIN OF OUR IDEAS OF THE SUBLIME AND BEAUTIFUL (1757)

SUMPTUARY (LAW)

sumptuary (adj.)

“pertaining to expense,” c. 1600, from Latin *sumptuarius* “relating to expenses,” from *sumptus* “expense, cost,” past participle of *sumere* “to borrow, buy, spend, eat, drink, consume, employ, take, take up,” contraction of **sub-emere*, from *sub* “under” (see sub-) + *emere* “to take, buy” (from PIE root **em-* “to take, distribute”).

sumptuous (adj.)

late 15c., from Old French *sumptueux* or directly from Latin *sumptuosus* “costly, very expensive; lavish, wasteful,” from *sumptus* (cf. sumptuary)

ONLINE ETYMOLOGY DICTIONARY (2020)

sumptuary (LAW)

1. a law regulating personal habits that offend the moral or religious beliefs of the community.
2. a law regulating personal expenditures designed to restrain extravagance, esp. in food and dress.

RANDOM HOUSE UNABRIDGED DICTIONARY OF AMERICAN ENGLISH (2020)

SUPER-

word-forming element meaning “above, over, beyond,” from Latin *super* (adverb and preposition) “above, over, on the top (of), beyond, besides, in addition to,” from *(s)uper-

variant form of PIE root *uper “over.” In English words from Old French, it appears as *sur-*. The primary sense seems to have shifted over time from usually meaning “beyond” to usually meaning “very much,” which can be contradictory. E.g. supersexual, which is attested from 1895 as “transcending sexuality,” from 1968 as “very sexual.”

ONILNE ETYMOLOGY DICTIONARY (2020)

T TEMPORALITY

“The most heterogeneous temporal elements thus coexist in the city. If we step from an eighteenth-century house into one from the sixteenth century, we tumble down the slope of time. Right next door stands a Gothic church, and we sink to the depths. A few steps farther, we are in a street from out of the early years of Bismarck’s rule ... , and once again climbing the mountain of time. Whoever sets foot in a city feels caught up as in a web of dreams, where the most remote past is linked to the events of today. One house allies with another, no matter what period they come from, and a street is horn. And then insofar as this street, which may go back to the age of Goethe, runs into another, which may date from the Wilhelmine years, the district emerges ... The climactic points of the city are its squares: here, from every direction, converge not only numerous streets but all the streams of their history. No sooner have they flowed in than they are contained; the edges of the square serve as quays, so that already the outward form of ’ the square provides information about the history that was played upon it. ... Things which find no expression in political events, or find only minimal expression, unfold in the cities: they are a superfine instrument, responsive as an

Aeolian harp-despite their specific gravity-to the living historic vibrations of the air.” Ferdinand Lion, *Geschichte biologisch gesehen* (Zürich and Leipzig, 1935), pp. 125-126, 128 (“Notiz über Städte”). [M 9, 4]

WALTER BENJAMIN, THE ARCADES PROJECT (1927-40)

TERRITORY

[...] The territory is in fact an act that affects milieus and rhythms, that ‘territorializes’ them. The territory is the product of a territorialization of milieus and rhythms. It amounts to the same thing to ask when milieus and rhythms become territorialized, and what the difference is between a non-territorial animal and a territorial animal. A territory borrows from all the milieus; it bites into them, seizes them bodily (although it remains vulnerable to intrusions). It is built from aspects or portions of milieus. It itself has an exterior milieu, an interior milieu, an intermediary milieu, and an annexed milieu. It has the interior zone of a residence or shelter, the exterior zone of its domain, more or less retractable limits or membranes, intermediary or even neutralized zones, and energy reserves or annexes. It is by essence marked by ‘indexes’, which may be components taken from any of the milieus: materials, organic products, skin or membrane states, energy sources, action-perception condensates. There is a territory precisely when milieu components cease to be directional, becoming dimensional instead, when they cease to be functional to become expressive. There is a territory when the rhythm has expressiveness. What defines the territory is the emergence of matters of expression (qualities). [...] The territory is first of all the critical distance between two beings of the same species: Mark your distance. What is mine is first of all my distance; I possess only

distances. Don't anybody touch me, I growl if anyone enters my territory, I put up placards. Critical distance is a relation based on matters of perception. It is a question of keeping at a distance the forces of chaos knocking at the door.

DELEUZE & GUATTARI, A THOUSAND PLATEAUS (1987)

TIME

Time must be brought into light—and genuinely conceived—as the horizon for all understanding of Being and for any way of interpreting it. In order for us to discern this, time needs to be *explicated primordially as the horizon for the understanding of Being, and in terms of temporality as the Being of Dasein, which understands Being*. M. HEIDEGGER, BEING AND TIME (1927/1962)

Indeed, nothing dies, everything exists always; no force can extinguish what once was. Every action, every word, every form, every thought fallen into the universal ocean of things sets circles off, that ripple out into eternity. Material figuration disappears only for vulgar eyes, and the phantoms that detach themselves inhabit the infinity. Paris continues to kidnap Helen in some unknown region in space.

THEOPHILE GAUTIER, ARRIA MARCELLA (1852) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

TOPOGRAPHICAL (CITY)

To construct the city topographically—tenfold and a hundred fold—from out of its arcades and its gateways, its cemeteries and bordellos, its railroad stations and its..., just as formerly it was defined by its churches and its markets. And the more

secret, more deeply embedded figures of the city: murders and rebellions, the bloody knots in the network of the streets, lairs of love, and conflagrations. [C1, 8] W. BENJAMIN, THE ARCADES PROJECT (1927–40)

TOPOLOGY

Topology is a branch of geometry which studies the qualitative rather than the quantitative properties of space. Topology investigates the kind of spatial continuity and reversibility that we find in a Möbius strip or a Klein bottle, recording the interchangeability of one surface with another. Bruce Morrisette, in applying topology to Robbe-Grillet's works, defines it as one of the "primary intellectual operations capable of revealing the modalities of surfaces, volumes, boundaries, contiguities, holes, and above all of the notions of inside and outside." Vicki Mistacco gives topology an additional metaphorical dimension in which the "production" of contemporary texts depends on the continuity and contiguity of both reader and writer. Topology, therefore, may refer to the spaces within a text as well as to the implied spatial relationship between the intrinsic text and the extrinsic reader—relationships which have ontological and perceptual implications.

Within the text, topology can signify the topography of a room, a house, a city, or a place. It elucidates structural relationships and configurations which may be stretched, twisted, and distorted. "In topology [says Robbe-Grillet] there are volumes whose inside is outside. There are surfaces where one side is on the other... in *Project pour une révolution*... the house, the street, and the keyhole... function as topological spaces. At times one has the impression that the whole house empties itself and that it

passes entirely through the keyhole, that the whole inside of the house becomes the outside.”

Topology is therefore more than a branch of geometry, or geography, or medicine. It deals with art, language, and perception. It is a dialectical space in which ontology and topography meet. Following Derrida’s dictum that “We have to unite or reconcile the two presentations (Darstellung) of the inside and the outside,” [...] Robbe-Grillet’s fiction, like Magritte’s painting, communicates the duality and simultaneity of creative perception. My eyes are the mediating surface between the outside and the inside, while consciousness itself records the phenomenon in all its complexity [...] Art, as a mediating agent, can be viewed as an extension of our sensory organs. And the distortions of our senses, though we may not be aware of them, as Magritte’s painting of an eye entitled *The False Mirror* implies, are perhaps as acute as those of Robbe-Grillet’s fiction. His rooms empty themselves through keyholes, while the insides of houses become the outside. His topology, his human condition, like Magritte’s, is indeed the dialectical space where ontology and topography meet. Doors, windows, and blinds, like the human eye, are the mediating agents between two seemingly opposed and irreconcilable spaces. Robbe-Grillet’s art unites them both in one transcendental leap.

BEN STOLTZFUS, ROBBE-GRILLET’S DIALECTICAL TOPOLOGY (1982)

TRAGEDY

ANTIGONE

–Take courage. Thou wilt live. [...]

SOPHOCLES, ANTIGONE (441 BC)

A basic issue is the relationship of the Greeks to pain, the degree of their sensitivity. Did this relationship remain constant? Or did it turn itself around? That question whether their constantly strong desire for beauty, feasts, festivities, and new cults arose out of some lack, deprivation, melancholy, or pain. If we assume that this desire for the beautiful and the good might be quite true [...] where must that contradictory desire stem from, which appears earlier than the desire for beauty, namely, the desire for the ugly or the good strong willing of the ancient Hellenes for pessimism, for tragic myth, for pictures of everything fearful, angry, enigmatic, destructive, and fateful as the basis of existence? Where must tragedy come from? Perhaps out of desire, out of power, out of overflowing health, out of overwhelming fullness of life? **FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE, THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY (1886)**

TRAIT

trait has a range of meanings not covered by any single word in English: Literally, it refers to a graphic drawing, and to the act of drawing a line. Abstractly, it is the purely graphic element. Figuratively, it is an identifying mark (a feature, or trait in the English sense), or any act constituting a mark or sign. In linguistics, “distinctive features” (*traits distinctifs* or *traits pertinents*) are the elementary units of language that combine to form a phoneme. *Trait* also refers to a projectile, especially an arrow, and to the act of throwing a projectile.

DELEUZE & GUATTARI, A THOUSAND PLATEAUS (1987) NOTES.

TYPE

[...] not only will the portrait of a woman by a great artist

not seek in the least to give satisfaction to various demands on the woman's part... It will, on the contrary, emphasize those very blemishes which she seeks to hide, and which (as for instance a sickly, almost greenish complexion) are all the more tempting to him since they show "character" [...] Fallen now, situated outside her own type in which she sat unassailably enthroned, she is now just an ordinary woman, in the legend of whose superiority we lost all faith. We are so accustomed to incorporating in this type not only the beauty of an Odette but her personality, her identity, the standing before the portrait that has thus stripped her of it we are inclined to protest not simply "How plain he has made her" but "Why, it isn't the least bit like her!" And yet there is a person there on the canvas whom we are quite conscious of having seen before. But that person is not Odette; the face of the person, her body, her general appearance seems familiar.

They recall to us not this particular woman who never held herself like that, whose natural pose never formed any such strange and teasing arabesque, but other women, all the women whom Eltsir has never painted, women, whom invariably, however they may differ from one another, he has chose to plant thus, in full face, [...] a large round hat in one hand, symmetrically corresponding, at the level of the knee which it covers, to that other disc, higher up in the picture, the face. **M. PROUST, À L'OMBRE DES JEUNES FILLES EN FLEUR (1919)**

U UTILITY

CYRANO *He raises his sword.*

What say you? It is useless? Ay, I know!

But who fights ever hoping for success?

I fought for lost cause, and for fruitless quest!

E. ROSTAND, CYRANO DE BERGERAC, ACT V.6 (1897) TRANS. VOLUPTAS

VALUE

V

Nowadays people know the price of everything, and the value of nothing.

OSCAR WILDE, THE PICTURE OF DORIAN GRAY (1891)

It remains true that value, of which money is but the sign, is nothing, absolutely nothing, if not a combination of entirely subjective things, of beliefs and desires, of ideas and volitions, and that the peaks and troughs of values in the stock market, unlike the oscillations of a barometer, could not even remotely be explained without considering their psychological causes: fits of hope or discouragement in the public, propagation of a good or bad sensational story in the minds of speculators. [...] It is a quality, such as color, that we attribute to things, but that, like color, exists only within us by way of a perfectly subjective truth. It consists in the harmonization of the collective judgments we make concerning the aptitude of objects to be more or less—and by a greater or lesser number of people—believed, desired or enjoyed. Thus, this quality belongs among those peculiar ones which, appearing suited to show numerous degrees and to go up or down this ladder without changing their essential nature, merit the name "quantity." **B. LATOUR & V. A. LEPINAY, THE SCIENCE OF PASSIONATE INTERESTS (2008)**

WEALTH

W

But when the time came for the gifts of wealth, he realised that of all the kindness between man and man none came with a more natural grace than the gifts of meat and drink.

XENOPHON, CRYOPEDIA: THE EDUCATION OF CRYUS, BOOK VIII, C.2.2 (370 BC)

Z ZEPHYR

Oh! how I love, on a fair summer's eve,
 When streams of light pour down the golden west,
 And on the balmy zephyrs tranquil rest
 The silver clouds, far – far away to leave
 All meaner thoughts, and take a sweet reprieve
 From little cares; to find, with easy quest,
 A fragrant wild, with Nature's beauty drest,
 And there into delight my soul deceive.
 There warm my breast with patriotic lore,
 Musing on Milton's fate – on Sydney's bier –
 Till their stern forms before my mind arise:
 Perhaps on wing of Poesy upsoar,
 Full often dropping a delicious tear,
 When some melodious sorrow spells mine eyes.

JOHN KEATS, OH! HOW I LOVE, ON A FAIR SUMMER'S EVE (1816)

Wild nights - Wild nights!
 Were I with thee
 Wild nights should be
 Our luxury!

Futile - the winds -
 To a Heart in port -
 Done with the Compass -
 Done with the Chart!

Rowing in Eden -
 Ah - the Sea!
 Might I but moor - tonight -
 In thee!

EMILY DICKINSON, WILD NIGHTS – WILD NIGHTS! (1861)